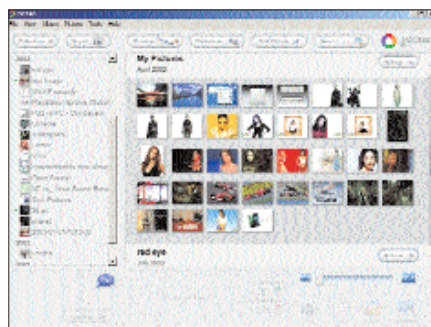




Picasa's interface is a pleasure to use

Folders are listed as separate albums, and you can import images from the camera or from albums—there is also an option to exclude duplicates that have same file name. Picasa has a picture tray in the bottom, to which you can drag images that you wish to club together—to view as a slideshow, print, e-mail, etc.

Picasa also has an innovative and original timeline. Unlike Photoshop Album, which has a static timeline, Picasa has a dynamic timeline—when you select 'Timeline,' the program goes into full-screen mode showing the timeline as an arc. The albums are arranged according to the date of the first image. So the timeline can be used more as a tool for general browsing, rather than for strict sequential viewing of images. In the full screen mode, however, the images are slightly blurred.

In the editing department, Picasa provides only three features—red eye removal, crop and single-click enhance. Another sore point is that it can't be used for viewing images. Double-clicking a thumbnail only gives a bigger view of the image, and you can't zoom. To view an image in full screen, you have to

enter the slideshow mode, which again shows blurry images.

This software is acceptable only for those who want an easy-to-use interface, and do not need even basic image editing features.

## Paint Shop Photo Album 4

Jasc's After Shot is now re-christened Paint Shop Photo Album. Compared to its adversaries (Adobe Photoshop Album and Ulead Photo Explorer) it is toothless, with an average interface and Explorer-style browsing. Though it uses the conventional interface, the buttons on the top provide access to all the important tools such as e-mail, slideshow, and print.



On the left pane there are four tabs—Browse, Search, Keywords and Info. The Browse tab displays a folder tree. The keywords tab reveals a preset list of keywords that you can add or remove from images. The Info tab reveals complete details of the selected images. Similarly, the Search tab brings up the search menu, from where you can perform a search based on a maximum of three parameters. You can't mix the parameters, for example, you can't search for all images with the keyword 'Family' and

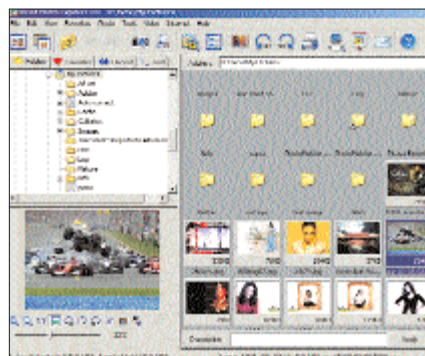


Photo Album has very easy-to-access controls

## Remove the Duplicates

Over a period of time, you may have a lot of duplicate files on your hard disk. Some of them may be exact copies, while others may be resized, rotated or cropped versions of the original. If you have a large collection of images, finding them is very hard. Photoshop Album allows you to search for images based on a visual comparison, but it won't find all duplicate entries.

A nifty utility called Unique Filer lets you find all the duplicate files in your hard disk. It performs a pixel level comparison of the images to find duplicate entries. Just specify the folders, and it will scan for duplicate files. Similarly, it can scan for other documents based on content, and on other parameters such as filename, size and contents.

file names starting with 'h'.

Double-clicking a thumbnail gives you a larger view of the picture, and clicking Adjust brings up the adjust wizard. This helps you adjust the image step-by-step, previewing the changes along the way. You can also add various effects such as adding frames, fisheye, ripples, etc. Although it has a tool for creating panoramic images (joining several images to get a larger image), we just could not make one, and ended up with just a collage of all the images we used.

Printing is another department where Photo Album excels. Click on Print to get a huge list of layout options in the right pane. You can use the Adjust tab to zoom, rotate or pan an individual image, or provide a caption for each image. Overall, Photo Album has a decent interface, excellent editing and



A menu-less interface drives the Photo Organizer

## PDA your Images

PDA users can use an application called PhotoMeister ([www.photomeister.com](http://www.photomeister.com)). This image management software allows you to create photo albums that can be viewed on your PDA. The creation process is fairly simple. Select the images, and click a button at the bottom. The wizard will ask you a series of simple questions, such as which OS your PDA runs and the resolution to be used. It then creates a photo album file that you can copy to your PDA. There are many other applications that do a similar job, such as Hero E-Photo Album ([www.heroshare.com](http://www.heroshare.com)).